

I Just Got My First Moving Job — Now What? The Complete Operations Guide

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The booking is confirmed. The customer is expecting you. Now the job needs to go flawlessly — because this first impression determines whether you get a 5-star review, a referral, and a repeat customer, or a bad review that follows your business for years.

Here's exactly how to execute from confirmation to follow-up.

The Day Before: Confirmation and Preparation

Send a confirmation text or call the evening before every move:

"Hey [Name], confirming your move tomorrow. We'll arrive between [time window]. A couple of quick things: please make sure the path to the truck is clear

and let us know if there are any stairs, tight hallways, or specialty items you didn't mention at booking. See you tomorrow!"

This simple message:

- Reduces no-access situations (locked gates, blocked driveways)
- Surfaces last-minute surprises before you're on-site
- Signals professionalism that sets you apart from most operators

Prepare your truck the night before:

- Blankets stocked and accessible
- Dollies secure and functional
- Straps organized
- Stretch wrap available
- Floor runners loaded
- Disassembly toolkit on board
- Fuel topped off

Showing up scrambling for equipment is a bad start to a move that needs to go smoothly.

Move Day: Arrival and Pre-Move Assessment

Arrive at the start of your window, not the end. If you said 9 to 11 AM, arriving at 10:30 is technically on time but creates anxiety. Aim for the early end.

Walk the job before touching anything. Spend 5 to 10 minutes with the customer:

- Walk every room that's being moved
- Identify specialty or fragile items
- Note any stairs, tight turns, or access challenges
- Confirm what's going and what's staying
- Take photos of anything pre-damaged (screens with existing cracks, furniture with existing scratches)

Why photos matter: If you don't document pre-existing damage, you may be blamed for it. A 30-second photo of a scratched dresser before you move it protects you from a claim later.

Set up properly before starting:

- Place floor runners on hardwood floors and carpeted stairs
- Install door frame protection on any door you'll be moving furniture through
- Back the truck as close as possible to minimize carry distance
- Brief your crew: assign roles (who wraps, who carries, staging order)

The Move Itself: Handling Standards

The quality of your handling is your reputation. Every scratch, every dent, every broken item is a potential bad review and a potential claim.

Furniture wrapping:

- Every piece of wooden furniture gets a moving blanket before it leaves the room
- No glass moves unwrapped
- Stretch wrap over blankets to secure them (not directly on wood — it can pull finish)
- Mattresses go in mattress bags before entering the truck

Carrying technique:

- Two-person lifts for anything heavy — no exceptions
- Use dollies for appliances and heavy furniture
- Stair dolly for anything going up or down stairs
- Call out "corner" and "stairs" before turns and level changes — crew communication prevents accidents

Loading the truck:

- Heavy items (appliances, furniture) go against the cab wall first
- Medium items next

- Light boxes and bags last and on top
- Every load secured with straps before moving the truck

Disassembly:

- Bed frames, desks, and large furniture often need to be broken down
- Keep all hardware in a labeled zip-lock bag taped to the piece it came from
- Take photos before disassembly if the reassembly sequence isn't obvious

At the Destination: Placement and Reassembly

Walk the destination before unloading. Know where every major piece is going before the first box comes off the truck. This prevents the most common moving frustration: "Can you move that again?" moments that add time and strain crew.

Ask about placement: "Where would you like the couch? Do you want the dresser on the left or right wall?" Customer input at this stage prevents disputes later.

Reassemble what you disassembled. If you took a bed frame apart, put it back together. Don't leave customers with hardware bags and an instruction to "just figure it out." Reassembly is part of the service.

Final walk-through with the customer:

- Walk through every room together
- Ask: "Is everything where you'd like it?"
- Note any items the customer wants repositioned (while you're still there)
- Confirm no items were left at the origin (common oversight, especially in garages and storage areas)

Payment Collection

Collect payment at completion of the destination unload — before the crew leaves.

Payment policy best practices:

- Accept multiple payment methods: cash, credit/debit, Venmo, Zelle, check
- Have your payment processing ready on your phone (Square, Stripe)

- Provide an itemized receipt: base hours, any overages, specialty fees, travel
- If there's any discrepancy, resolve it on-site while everyone is present

If there's damage discovered at the destination:

- Acknowledge it calmly and professionally
- Take photos immediately
- Do NOT admit liability or offer an immediate refund on the spot
- Collect payment for the move
- Follow up within 24 hours with a resolution proposal
- Resolving damage claims quickly and fairly protects reviews far better than avoiding the conversation

The Follow-Up: Where Reviews Are Won or Lost

Within 24 hours of job completion, send this text:

"Hey [Name], it was great helping with your move! Hope you're getting settled in. If everything went well, a quick Google review would mean a lot to us — it only takes 2 minutes and helps other families find us: [direct Google review link]. Thanks, [Your Name]"

Why 24 hours? The move is fresh. The relief of being in the new place is fresh. The customer's goodwill toward you is at its peak. Waiting a week means the moment has passed.

At 15 to 20% conversion on your review requests, 15 jobs per month generates 2 to 3 reviews per month. In 12 months: 24 to 36 reviews that compound into organic traffic and new customers.

The Post-Move Checklist

- ☐ Confirmation sent night before
- ☐ Truck prepared night before
- ☐ Arrived at start of window
- ☐ Pre-move walk-through with customer completed

- ☐ Existing damage documented with photos
- ☐ Floor runners and door protection installed
- ☐ Crew briefed and roles assigned
- ☐ All furniture wrapped before leaving rooms
- ☐ Truck loaded securely and strapped
- ☐ Destination walk-through before unloading
- ☐ Customer input on placement received
- ☐ All disassembled furniture reassembled
- ☐ Final walk-through with customer completed
- ☐ Payment collected with itemized receipt
- ☐ Review request sent within 24 hours

This checklist takes minutes to run. The operators who run it consistently on every job have dramatically fewer claims, better reviews, and more referrals than those who work by feel.

Ready to fill your schedule with jobs to run this process on? Book a free strategy call and let's talk about what's available in your market.